

1. The Origin Story

JavaScript was created in **1995** by **Brendan Eich** while working at Netscape. In a feat of engineering (and extreme pressure), the first version was written in just **10 days**.

- **Original Names:** It was first called *Mocha*, then *LiveScript*.
- **The "Java" Branding:** The name was changed to JavaScript as a marketing move to ride the wave of popularity that the Java language was experiencing at the time, despite the two being very different.

2. Standardization: ECMAScript

To ensure the language worked across different browsers, it was standardized by ECMA International.

- **ECMAScript (ES):** This is the official specification.
- **ES6 (2015):** A massive turning point for the language, introducing features like `let/const`, arrow functions, and classes, which modernized the syntax.

3. Evolution and Power

Initially a simple tool for form validation and basic animations, JS has become the backbone of the modern web:

- **The V8 Engine:** Created by Google, this engine uses Just-In-Time (JIT) compilation to execute code at near-native speeds.
- **Node.js:** Released in 2009, it allowed JavaScript to run on servers, enabling developers to build entire applications (Frontend and Backend) using a single language.